

Tamil Nadu to purchase 640 electric buses and set up 260 charging points

Tamil Nadu government is working on the cost involved in purchasing 640 electric buses and setting up 260 charging points for them. As per reports, Pallavan Transport Consultancy Services (PTCS) has floated a tender for the direct supply of e-buses under Central government's Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of Electric Vehicles (FAME-II) scheme. Meanwhile, the Centre is expected to provide a subsidy between five million rupees and 5.5 million rupees for each e-bus, cost of which will range between fifteen and twenty million rupees.

Noida Authority's LED project receives government award

Noida Authority's project of replacing 74,000 conventional streetlights with modern LED lights has been selected for an award in energy efficiency category by Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA). A senior official in the ministry said the project, which is expected to save 56 per cent energy, is one of the recipients of Smart City – Empowering India Awards.

UP will become destination for A&D manufacturing: Rajnath Singh

Defence minister Rajnath Singh has said that DefExpo 2020 will help Uttar Pradesh become a destination for aerospace and defence (A&D) manufacturing. He also said that several companies have agreed to sign MoUs during the event. Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath said that the state's policy on investment in defence manufacturing is one of the best.

Government of India's UJALA and SLNP complete five successful years

Launched by Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi on January 5, 2015, the government of India's zero-subsidy Unnat Jyoti by Affordable LEDs for All (UJALA) and LED Street Lighting National Programme (SLNP) completed five successful years of illuminating India last month. SLNP is the world's largest streetlight replacement programme, and UJALA is the world's largest domestic lighting project. Both have been spearheaded and implemented by Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL), a joint venture of PSUs under Ministry of Power, government of India.

AIIB announces US\$ 65 million for a 250MW solar project in Rajasthan

Beijing-based Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) has announced a loan of US\$ 210 million for irrigation and solar energy

projects in India. The institution will lend US\$ 65 million for a 250MW solar project in Rajasthan promoted by Hero Future Energies. As per the official statement, there are plans to ramp up the capacity to 616MW by 2022.

Mercedes Benz enters EV space in India

Luxury car manufacturer Mercedes-Benz India has entered the electric vehicle (EV) space. Under EQ brand, the company will launch its first EV, EQC EV in April 2020. Martin Schwenk, managing director and chief executive officer, Mercedes-Benz India said, "With the launch of EQ we firmly announce Mercedes-Benz's arrival into the new era of electro mobility. We want EQ brand to create an ecosystem in which electric mobility is reliable, simple and at the same time exciting."

Intel dethrones Samsung for top semiconductor market position

Samsung, the smartphone manufacturer and electronics giant, has been beaten by Intel for the top spot in the semiconductor market. The former had initially broken the latter's 24-year-long streak at the top but has now fallen short. Samsung is well-known for its consumer-grade electronic products like home appliances, smartphones and more. But it is also an industry giant in the chip making market, with memory chips and other products.

One billion 5G connections by 2023: Qualcomm

According to a report by IANS, Qualcomm president Cristiano Amon stated that the new technology is expected to surpass the conservative target of 200 million 5G devices set prior to 2020. He elaborated that electric growth of the new technology would ensure that by 2022, the number of shipped 5G smartphones will be over 750 million, and 5G connections should beat one billion by 2023, two years faster than 4G hit that number.

element14 helps millions of students across the globe learn with BBC micro:bit

element14 is working to support product-led educational initiatives globally. These programmes aim to create fun and interactive learning opportunities for students to develop an understanding of computing and electronics at a young age, and build a pathway to a range of engineering- and technology-driven careers. One of the latest programs to be supported by element14 is the series of how-to videos featuring BBC micro:bit.

Nokia presented an advanced 5G roadmap that will enable 5G for Vodafone in all spectrum bands currently in use for 4G, and implementation of new-generation 5G Massive MIMO antennae, delivering substantially increased gains in capacity and performance.

The agreement between Vodafone and Nokia is for a term of at least five years. It enables Vodafone to place orders with Nokia for site delivery, allowing the former to scale the pace of its 5G rollout according to requirements.

Thomson gets Android licence to make TVs in India

Thomson TV is set to become the first TV player in the country to make Google's Android-powered TVs entirely in India using inhouse backward integration manufacturing. The company is among six electronics brands such as Sony and TCL to have acquired the licence from Google to manufacture and sell Android-powered TV sets.

According to Avneet Singh Marwah, chief executive officer, Super

Plastronics, which has the brand licensee of Thomson, the company started importing Android TVs in India from China last year; looking at the great response it received, Google has decided to give it the licence to manufacture Android TVs end-to-end in India.

Noida-headquartered Super Plastronics, which has three manufacturing facilities in India, is looking at further expansion this year. The company already has an R&D centre in Bengaluru, and is now looking at a bigger centre.